

'13 H[enry] 4, cap. 7.

'Looke to the Justices of peace that are turbulent or neglecte there duties: for you that are Judges of Assise, the kinge hathe made Choyse of you for men of learninge & integritie, & hathe made you the visitors of his kingedome principallie & speciallie for the preservation of the peace of the lande. & to punishe depopulators wth all seueritie: to looke Carefullye to sherifes and vndersheriffes & there officers, whoe buye & selle the people, & retorne base & simple iurors: & yo^r Constables for the moste parte are the simpleste & meaneste of the people, a greate Faulte.'

In Camera Stellata, coram Consilio ibidem, Mercurij, 14 Octobr. 1607, adonque presente, Ellsmere, Lo. Chauncellor; Dorsette, Lo. Tresorer; Northampton; euesque de Londres, Rains; Lo. Zouche; Flemminge, Ch. Justice¹; Coke, Ch. Justice del Common place; S^r Julius Cesar, Chauncellor del exchequer, le primer temps que il seie en ceo Courte.²

1607
Oct. 14

Cause of hearing between Baron Snegge,³ plaintiff, Sherston,⁴ Mayor of Bath and Justice of the Peace, and others, defendants, in the matter of a riot. Sherston, being a lessee for years, and having paid his rent for fifteen years to Baron Snegge, at the end of his term, when the Baron was in the King's service on the Northern Circuit,

SNEGGE
v.
SHERSTON
and others
Riot

¹ Sir John Popham, Chief Justice of the King's Bench, died on June 10th, 1607; Sir Thomas Fleming, Chief Baron of the Exchequer, was appointed Chief Justice on June 25th following.

² See *post*, p. 336, n. 3.

³ Sir George Snigge was born at Bristol *cir.* 1545; admitted to the Middle Temple, 1567; called to the Bar, 1575; Treasurer, 1602; Recorder of Bristol, 1592 to 1604; appointed Baron of the Exchequer, 14 Oct. 1604; *ob.* 11 Nov. 1617; buried in S. Stephen's church, Bristol. See Evans, *Hist. of Bristol*, ii.

181; Barrett, *Hist. and Ant. of Bristol*, 514.

⁴ William Sherstone was the first Mayor of Bath under the Charter granted by Queen Elizabeth in 1590. The rent mentioned in the text was in respect of Berton farm in the parish of Walcott, which had been purchased by Sir George Snigge from Edmund Colthurste. The citizens claimed certain rights of common in this property, which led to a further dispute with William Snigge after the Baron's death. The matter was eventually settled by arbitration in 1619. See Warner's *Hist. of Bath*, 186.